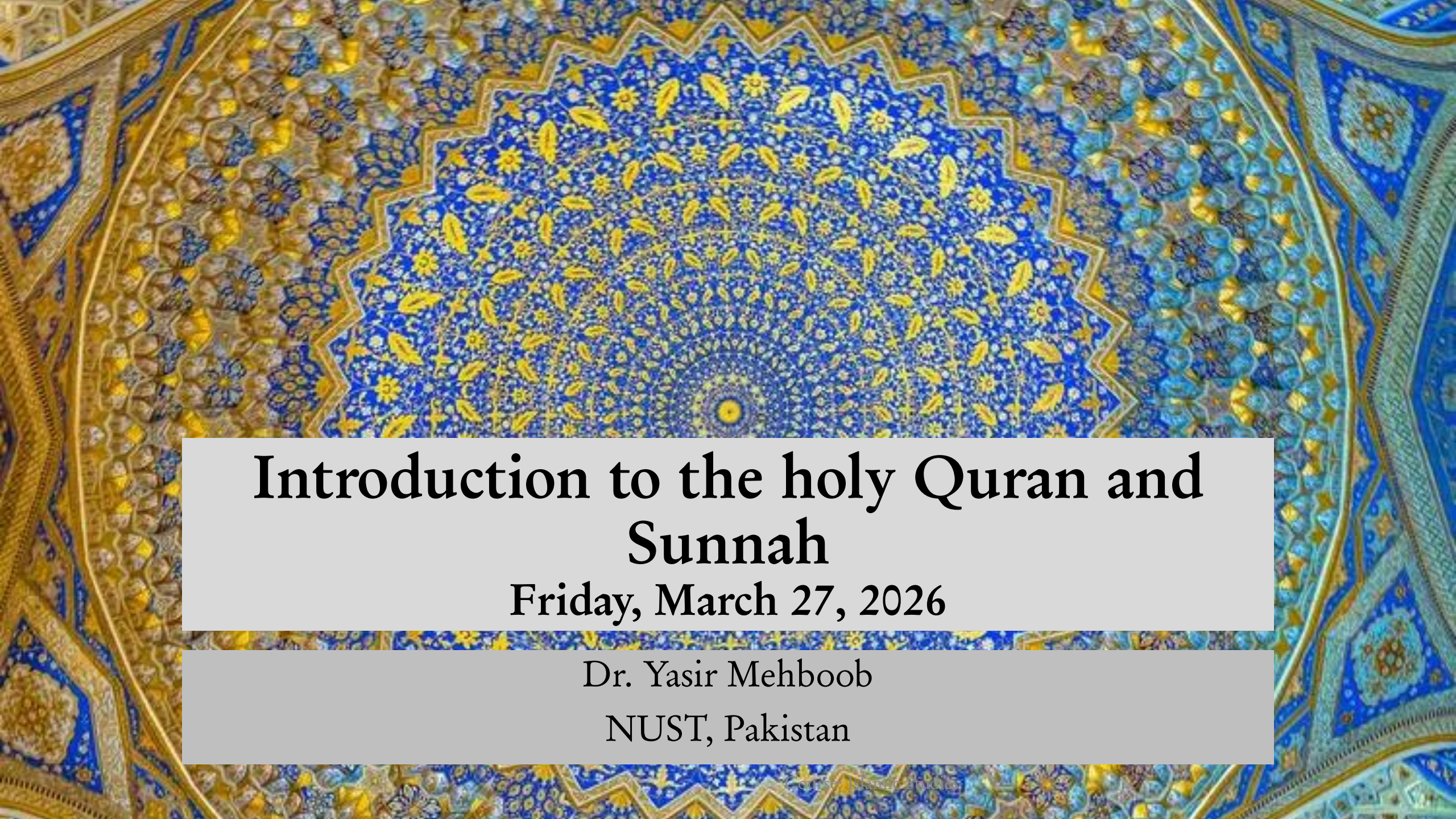


Introduction to the holy Quran and Sunnah

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بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

Today's Topics

- Introduction to the Quran and its Structure
- Composition of the holy Quran
- Living by the holy Quran: Etiquettes and Daily Application



Introduction to the Quran and its Structure

- The word *Qur'ān* (القرآن) literally means *"the recitation"* or *"that which is recited."* Its divine purpose is not merely to be read, but to be internalized, reflected (تدبُّر), and lived. The Qur'ān is the eternal Word of Allah, not a creation, and it encompasses guidance in creed, worship, morality, law, and spirituality.
- The Noble Quran stands as the eternal miracle revealed to Prophet Muhammad (Sallallahu Alayhi Wasallam) through the angel Jibreel (Alayhis Salam). Unlike any other scripture, it emerged from the mouth of a single messenger over twenty-three years, carrying the pure, unaltered Word of Allah (Azzawajal) to all of humanity until the Day of Judgment.



Introduction to the Quran and its Structure

For believers, scholars, and seekers alike, understanding the Quran represents an urgent necessity. It serves as:

- **The Complete Guide** to living as a servant of Allah
- **The Final Message** that supersedes and reiterates the basic religion ordained for Jews, Christians, and Muslims
- **The Source of Judgment** by which all humanity—believers and disbelievers—will be judged on Yawm al-Qiyamah (Day of Resurrection)



The Sacred Structure

The Quran comprises **114 chapters (surahs)** of varying lengths, containing approximately **6,200 verses (ayahs)**—each ayah literally meaning "a sign" from Allah. This organization reflects divine wisdom:

- **Arrangement by Wisdom, Not Chronology:**
- The Quran is not arranged chronologically but by divine decree
- The longest surah (Al-Baqarah with 6,100 words) appears second
- The shortest surahs appear toward the end
- Each placement serves spiritual and pedagogical purposes



Practical Organization for Study

For ease of recitation and memorization, early Muslim scholars divided the Quran into **thirty portions (juz')** of roughly equal length. This practical division:

- Facilitates daily reading goals
- Enables completion during Ramadan (one juz' per night)
- Aids memorization efforts
- Appears as markers on page sides without affecting the sacred structure



Introduction to the Quran and its Structure

- **Makkan Revelation (First 13 years):**
  - Focus on Tawheed (Oneness of Allah)
  - Stories of previous prophets and nations
  - Descriptions of Paradise and Hellfire
  - Building strong faith foundations
  - Shorter, powerful verses
- **Madinan Revelation (Last 10 years):**
  - Detailed legal rulings (Shariah)
  - Social, economic, and political legislation
  - Community building guidelines
  - Longer, detailed verses
  - Practical implementation of faith



Composition of the holy Quran

- The book *Structural Cohesion in the Quran: Heavenly Order* explores how the Quran is not a random collection of verses but a meticulously organized text. It highlights **naẓm** (composition) as a key to understanding divine eloquence, showing that Allah's speech mirrors the order found in creation itself. The author outlines five reasons for studying Quranic structure: its perfection as divine speech, parallels with the harmony of the universe, rebuttal of claims of disorganization, wisdom in its non-chronological arrangement, and its role as a tool for interpretation.



Composition of the holy Quran

- Examples include **parallelism** (e.g., Sūrat al-Māʿūn and Sūrat al-Kawthar, where qualities of the denier are contrasted with Allah's generosity) and **ring composition** (e.g., Āyat al-Kursī, structured symmetrically around God's knowledge and authority). The book also examines **mirror structures** in stories like Moses in Sūrat al-Qaṣaṣ, and **integrative coherence**, where repeated words or themes link passages. Ultimately, it argues that every sūrah has a central theme, reinforcing the Quran's unity and divine order.



Composition of the holy Quran

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b5Y5gMc_XZo



Etiquettes and Daily Application

- Approaching the Quran demands adab (etiquette) befitting its majesty—a covenant of purity and presence that elevates recitation to intimate dialogue with the Divine.



Etiquettes

- **Physical Purity:**
- Maintain wudu (ablution) when touching the Quran: *"None shall touch it except the purified"* (56:79)
- Place the Quran on a clean, elevated surface—never on the floor
- Keep it wrapped or covered when not in use
- **Respectful Handling:**
- Use a Quran stand (rehal) when reading
- Turn pages gently
- Do not place other books on top of the Quran
- Carry it with your right hand or hold it close to your chest



Spiritual Preparation for Recitation

Seeking Refuge: Before reciting, say: "A'udhu billahi minash shaytanir rajeem" (I seek refuge with Allah from the accursed Satan) as commanded in Surah An-Nahl (16:98).

Presence of Heart:

- Recite with contemplation (tadabbur), not merely to finish pages
- Pause at verses of mercy to ask Allah for His grace
- Pause at verses of punishment to seek His protection
- Pause at verses of glorification to exalt Allah

Proper Tajweed: Learn basic tajweed rules.

- Beautifying your voice as encouraged by the holy Prophet, peace and blessings upon him
- Pronouncing letters from their proper articulation points
- Observing lengthening (madd) rules
- Recognizing places to pause (waqf)



Daily Application

Allah (SWT) did not reveal the Quran merely for recitation or intellectual study—He revealed it to be **lived**. The Companions (Radiyallahu Anhum) exemplified this approach. They would learn ten verses, understand their meanings, implement them in their lives, and only then proceed to the next ten verses.



Daily Application

The Quran is not only a book to be recited, but a way of life to be lived. Every Muslim must see it as the compass that directs the heart and the soul. To live by the Quran is to recognize that our purpose is not limited to eating, sleeping, or chasing worldly desires, but to worship Allāh ﷻ in every action. Islam is not limited to prayer and fasting, it covers honesty in speech, kindness to parents, fairness in trade, patience in hardship and more. The Quran teaches us that this world is a test, and the real success is to meet Allāh ﷻ with a heart that lived by His words. For this reason, the ultimate goal of a Muslim is to shape his or her life around the Quran, so that it becomes light in the grave, guidance on the Day of Judgment, and a bridge to Jannah.



The Quran as Life's Blueprint

In Personal Character: The Quran transforms character through direct commands:

- *"Do not be rude in speech"* (3:159)
- *"Restrain anger"* (3:134)
- *"Forgive others for their mistakes"* (7:199)
- *"Lower your voice"* (31:19)
- *"Do not ridicule others"* (49:11)

When Sayyidah Aisha (RA) was asked about the Prophet's character, she responded: *"His character was the Quran"*—the ultimate testimony to living by divine guidance.



The Quran as Life's Blueprint

- **In Family Relationships:**
  - *"Be dutiful to parents"* (17:23)
  - *"Live with them [spouses] in kindness"* (4:19)
  - *"And those who say, 'Our Lord, grant us from among our spouses and offspring comfort to our eyes'"* (25:74)
- **In Social Interactions:**
  - *"Be good to others"* (4:36)
  - *"Speak to people mildly"* (20:44)
  - *"Give full measure when you measure, and weigh with an even balance"* (17:35)
  - *"Help one another in righteousness and piety, but do not help one another in sin and transgression"* (5:2)



Practical Life Application

- **Decision Making:** Before major decisions, consult the Quran's principles:
  - Is this action pleasing to Allah?
  - Does it align with Quranic values of justice, mercy, and integrity?
  - What would the Prophet (PBUH) do in this situation based on Quranic guidance?
- **Behavioral Modification:** Identify one Quranic command each week and consciously implement it:
  - Week 1: Controlling anger (3:134)
  - Week 2: Speaking gently (20:44)
  - Week 3: Being patient with difficulties (2:153)
  - Week 4: Showing gratitude (14:7)



Practical Life Application

- **Financial Ethics:**
  - Avoid riba (interest/usury) as commanded: *"O you who believe, fear Allah and give up what remains of your demand for riba"* (2:278)
  - Give zakah and charity regularly
  - Earn through halal means only
  - Spend moderately: *"And those who, when they spend, are neither extravagant nor niggardly, but hold a just balance between those extremes"* (25:67)



Spiritual Transformation

- **Developing Taqwa (God-Consciousness):** The Quran repeatedly calls believers to taqwa—living with awareness that Allah sees all actions, hears all words, and knows all thoughts. This consciousness:
  - Prevents sins when alone
  - Motivates good deeds
  - Creates inner peace
  - Prepares for the Hereafter
- **Building Hope and Trust:** The Quran balances fear of Allah's punishment with hope in His mercy:
- *"Indeed, the mercy of Allah is near to the doers of good"* (7:56)
- *"And whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it"* (99:7)
- *"And He is with you wherever you are"* (57:4)



Community and Social Justice

- **Establishing Justice:**
  - *"O you who believe, be persistently standing firm in justice, witnesses for Allah"* (4:135)
  - Support the oppressed
  - Speak truth to power
  - Ensure fair treatment for all
- **Caring for the Vulnerable:**
  - Orphans: *"And give to the orphans their properties"* (4:2)
  - Neighbors: *"Worship Allah and associate nothing with Him, and to parents do good, and to relatives, orphans, the needy, the near neighbor, the neighbor farther away"* (4:36)
  - The poor: Establish regular charity beyond obligatory zakah





Seventh level
Abandonment of Practice

Sixth level
Abandonment of reflection

Fifth level
Forgetter of Quran after memorizing

Fourth level
Abandonment of reading

Third level
Example: un-attentive Muslims

Second level
Example: Many ignorant human beings.

Worst level
Example : Pagan Arabs of Mecca

Incorporating Quran in Daily Activities

- In Salah:
  - Vary your recitation in prayers—don't always recite the same surahs
  - Reflect on meanings during recitation
  - Extend night prayers (Qiyam) with longer Quran portions
- In Times of Need:
  - Seek guidance through Quranic duas
  - Find solace in verses of comfort during difficulties
  - Celebrate successes by reading verses of gratitude



Incorporating Quran in Daily Activities

- In Family Life:
  - Gather family for Quran time, even 15 minutes daily
  - Teach children short surahs and their meanings
  - Discuss one verse at family meals
  - Make Quran recitation part of your home's ambiance
  - Make your family decisions in the light of the holy Quran
- In Community:
  - Attend or organize Tafsir classes
  - Share Quranic reflections with friends (with proper knowledge)
  - Support Quran schools and hafiz programs

